rehab regime called for him to go up and down a climbing wall that day.

I hung around, watched.

He settled into a harness, grabbed a rope, shimmied up the wall. He gave a rousing whoop and cheer at the top, then a wave, then climbed back down.

I was astounded. I'd never been so proud—to be British, to be a soldier, to be his brother in arms. I told him so. I told him I wanted to buy him a beer for getting to the top of that wall. No, no, a crate of beer.

He laughed. *Wouldn't say no to that, mate!*

He said something about wanting to run a marathon.

I said if he ever did, when he did, he'd find me waiting at the finish line.

27.

TOWARDS THE END OF that summer I went to Botswana, met up with Teej and Mike. They'd recently done masterwork on the David Attenborough series *Planet Earth*, and a few other BBC films, and now they were shooting an important film about elephants. Several herds, stressed by habitat encroachment and drought, were stampeding into Namibia in search of food, running straight into the arms of poachers—hundreds, armed with AK-47s. Teej and Mike hoped their film might shine a light on this rolling massacre.

I asked if I could help. They didn't hesitate. *Course, Spike.*

In fact, they offered to hire me as a credited, though unpaid, cameraman.

From Day One they talked about how *different* I seemed. Not that I wasn't always a hard worker, but clearly I'd learned from the Army how to take direction. They never had to tell me anything twice.

Many times during that shoot we'd be riding around the bush in their flatbed truck and I'd gaze off and think: How bizarre. My whole life I've despised photographers, because they specialize in stealing your freedom,